

EL TORBELLINO

NEWSLETTER OF SAN DIEGO ORBITEERS FREE FLIGHT CLUB



March 2026

The Prez's Corner – Don Bartick

Ramblings

Well, here I go again. Back at the helm of the Orbiteers. A special thanks to Mark Chomyn, who led the organization after me over the last several years. He chose to step down, not only as President/COB but also as a Board member. Thank you Mark for your years of service.

We are now left with 5 Board Members. Of the five, there were no volunteers to take on the leadership. Without a President, the club couldn't be sanctioned by AMA. And without being sanctioned, we couldn't conduct sanctioned contests. That would include our monthlies at Perris and our annual Dual-clubs Bonanza at Lost Hills. All of which are National Cup events. Not saying that we couldn't hold unsanctioned contests, but then we wouldn't have the liability insurance that a sanction provides.

Unfortunately, San Diego now has a very small Free Flight Community to draw from. Especially, outdoor free flight. Our membership extends throughout Southern California, but to draw from them for leadership would mean going to Zoom meetings. This is how the Lost Hills Free Flight Model Airfield Association conducts business. I didn't want that to happen with the Orbiteers.

We once had General meetings along with indoor flying, led by the club president. 20-25 members would attend and afterwards most of us would go to a local pizza restaurant for social time. Then, we kept losing sites large enough to have our meetings and enjoy flying indoor models. Finally, no available sites. This precipitated in the decision to run the club with a Board of Directors. We had plenty of San Diego members to draw from in order to fill the Board positions. The Board meetings would be held at a Board member's home for lunch and the meeting. The Minutes of the meetings were published in the El Torbellino. This worked out great for the last many years. But with declining San Diego membership via relocation and death, we're now at the point that finding leadership for the club is in peril. This happened recently with the SCAMPS club. Their leadership got too old or died away and no one wanted to step in to fill the leadership roles. This led to their demise. They are no more! This was once the oldest Free Flight club in Southern California.

I for one didn't want that to happen to our club. So here you are with me at 86. I promise to serve the best I can, but on a "temporary" basis. As you can understand, one way or another I'm temporary. I can only hope, that someone will eventually bail me out. Is that someone----you?

Indoor Flying

On another note, we now have a wonderful venue for Indoor Flying. It isn't free like Grossmont College, but better. Our hobby is dog gone cheap compared to other hobbies. Why are we having attendance problems? Please ask yourself: Why am I not flying Indoor? You love Free Flight and you love indoor. Maybe you haven't flown Indoor before. Well, look at the upside. Cheap to build. No Weather issues and the Chases are very, very short. Doesn't get better than that. Come on folks. Join us for lots of fun. If you don't have any Indoor planes, come anyway. We have planes to loan you. We need more flyers to help with the cost of renting the gym. If you can't make it, then help with the cost. Any donation welcomed. Send to Howard Haupt.

Well, that's it Orbiteers, wherever you're at.

Remember: Simplicity is the Ultimate Sophistication (Leonardo de Vinci). Think about that!

BOARD OF TRUSTEES



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ORBITEERS MEMBERSHIP DUES

Annual Membership - \$20
Lifetime Membership - \$250
Non-Member Newsletter Subscription - \$15
Junior Members 16 years old or younger - Free

Submit Dues to Club Treasurer:

Howard Haupt
3860 Ecochee Avenue
San Diego, CA 92117-4622

THE FINE PRINT THE FINE PRINT

El Torbellino is the official newsletter of the San Diego Orbiteers, an Academy of Model Aeronautics (AMA) Charter Club (#1113) and a California not for Profit Corporation. This newsletter is sent monthly to all paid members, selected exchange and magazine editors. Non-Members may subscribe at \$15.00 per year within the U.S.A., offshore price will be adjusted to reflect the postage required. Materials from El Torbellino may be reproduced on an unlimited basis by other publications, but proper credit is requested.

ORBITEER WEB SITE

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Hip Pocket Aeronautics Website Returns

By Mike Jester



Rejoice! Hip Pocket Aeronautics (HPA) has returned. For many years it was the premier website where free flight modelers from around the world could share pictures and stories of their creations and techniques. Then a couple of years ago it crashed. A few months later HPA came back to life. It turned out that the principal administrator had passed away unexpectedly. His assistant eventually got HPA back up and running. But the original content was lost - thousands of useful posts were gone. Over the next year or two the new administrator struggled with bots hacking the second iteration of HPA and a slew of technical challenges. The workload and the meager donations were insufficient to overcome the trials and tribulations. Late last November, the second iteration of HPA went dead. However, within that past couple of months a third iteration of HPA has emerged. The moderator is a very competent model builder and IT person that resides in Greece. But all the posts are in English. Over 240 people have joined as members and more content is being uploaded every week. Please consider joining the third iteration of HPA here:

<https://hpa.aeromodelling.gr/index.php>

I have been visiting the new HPA frequently. I find the website to be easy to use, very entertaining, and a valuable resource for sharing pictures of our creations, builds, trimming advice, and construction techniques.

On a different note, at one time the F6F-5 Hellcat was the premier US Navy fighter plane. It was produced in large numbers and primarily served in the Pacific during WWII. Did you know that it only cost \$60,000 back then? How times have changed.



Grumman F6F-5 Hellcat, US Navy, VF-16, CV-15 USS Randolph, ca. 1945

SAN DIEGO ORBITEERS BOARD MEETING - J.Merrill



Meeting held at the Bartick's home on Wednesday, March 11th, 2026;
with 6 in attendance, including 1 by phone. Called to order at 12:45 PM.

Minutes of the previous meeting were approved as published.

Treasury report approved as provided to the board.

Old Business:

Our charter and insurance is up to date through March, 2027.

Indoor flying needs more participation to keep the gym. It's a good facility.

Sadly, we learned of indoor flyer Richard Wood passing away. He used to drive from Arizona to fly at the Grossmont College gym.

Website: Mike Jester is coordinating with Jake to make some minor adjustments.

Discussed Mike Jester's proposal to the AMA regarding the P-30 event. All board members agreed.

New Business:

Orbiteers Future: we very much wish to keep the club going. Too many clubs have gone away because nobody wants to step up and help run the club. Our former president has resigned (we appreciate all his time and efforts!), and we need a new one.

Thankfully, Don Bartick has agreed to take over the presidency FOR NOW.

Given this, we very much need to request some fresh board members, especially someone who would be willing to take the helm.

Good of the Order:

Next meeting will be at the Merrill's house, tentatively scheduled for June 24th.

Meeting adjourned at 2:30 PM

Respectfully submitted by John R. Merrill, amateur secretary.

(Some editing and formatting by the editor)



February 2026 Outdoor Monthly Results

CD John Merrill

Coupe-

- 1st- Greg Hutchison
- 2nd- David Wade

CLG

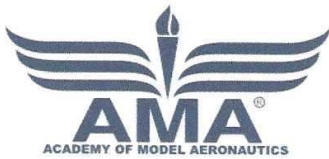
- 1st- David Wade
- 2nd- Chris
- 3rd- John Merrill



Photos by Arline Bartick

February 2026 Outdoor Monthly Photos (Continued) - Photos by Arline Bartick





YOUR PASSION. HOBBY. ONE COMMUNITY.
Academy of Model Aeronautics 5161 E. Memorial Dr. Muncie IN 47302 | (765) 287-1256 | modelaircraft.org

Proposal Number: OFF28-3

Received Date: 2/19/2026

Revised Date:

Version Number:

Proposal Type

Basic

Applicable Competition Regulations this proposal relates to:

Outdoor Free Flight

Give Brief Summary of the Proposed Change

The proposed change to the rules for the P-30 event would prohibit the use of auto-fuctions such as variable tail incidence (VIT), auto rudder, and wing wiggler.

State exact wording proposed for the Competition Regulations.

Paragraph 1.1 would be amended by adding the language in brackets below to the end of the paragraph. The brackets are only being included to highlight the proposed amendment and should not appear in the amended rules should they be approved.

1.1. No part of the model shall exceed 30 inches when it is in assembled condition [and its wing, stabilizer, and fin(s) shall remain fixed throughout each official flight except upon the triggering of a de-thermalizer (DT)].

State logic behind proposed change, including alleged shortcoming of the present rule(s).

I am a member of the San Diego Orbiters free flight club. Two members of the club (now deceased) were primarily responsible for developing the rules for the P-30 event in the late 1970's. It has since grown to be one of the most popular, if not the most popular, outdoor free flight event in the world. Currently there are at least twenty (20) commercially available P-30 kits including the laser-cut short kit for the Three Nite P-30 which I designed and which is sold by Volare Products. The original intent of the P-30 event was to provide an inexpensive, entry level outdoor rubber powered free flight event suitable for beginners yet challenging for experienced fliers. Indeed, the very first outdoor free flight event I competed in was P-30 and I won the event flying against nine experienced fliers with my Square Eagle P-30 that I built and trimmed myself. Increasingly P-30 models are being developed, publicized, and flown that include auto-functions. VIT in particular provides a huge advantage over a locked down P-30. I do not want to see P-30 go the route of the F1B (Wakefield) and F1G (Coupe) events where one must buy an expensive high-tech auto-function model built in Eastern Europe in order to be competitive. Home-built P-30 models with auto-functions are far more complex to build and more expensive to build than simple, locked down P-30 models.

If this proposal is for a new event, include all event test data/information here.

Articles have been published in the AMA's magazine and in Free Flight Quarterly documenting the advantages of auto-function P-30 models. YouTube videos exist that show the structure and function of

VIT on a P-30 model.

State effect, if any, on current AMA records:

I do not believe that the proposed amendment would have any effect on current P-30 records. If there is a record it is probably around an eleven-minute flight by Don DeLoach.

AMA Number

908204

Contact Information

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Accompanying Documents

- [square-eagle-p-30-by-mike-jester.jpg](#)
- [three-nite-p-30-launch---march-2021.jpg](#)
- [three-nite-p-30---uncovered.jpg](#)
- [three-nite-p-30-by-mike-jester---3rd-build.jpg](#)
- [three-nite-p-30-reduced-plan-march-20,-2021.jpg](#)
- [p-30-kits.pdf](#)
- [rising-light-ag---layout.pdf](#)
- [rising-light-ag---dt.pdf](#)

Below is a picture of the Jimmy Allen Bluebird that was given to me by Greg Hutchison. It was started by John but never finished. I consider it an honor to complete the build. My only construction task was to build the stab. Not an easy task as it required a spar that passed through the fuselage. Setting up a DT for this will take some thinking.

The other photo is a Hoot Owl produced by Supreme Models of Wisconsin probably in the early 1940's. It was likely marketed as a beginners' model. The beginners' tag may be true for the wings, stab and rudders, but building the fuselage was not a simple task. Fuselage 1/16-inch square cross pieces were only 3/8-inch long. My fat fingers required the use of tweezers to get them in place. I can imagine that a beginner back in the 1940s using old fashioned cellulose glue (Ambroid) may have gotten discouraged and given up. If I remember my childhood building skills, I think I may have thrown in the towel. The Owl only has a span of 12-inches, but the plans mention that it is legal for Old Timer and Two-Bit flying events. I hope to take both to the 2-day Scale Staffel contest on February 28.

- Mark



Blue Bird



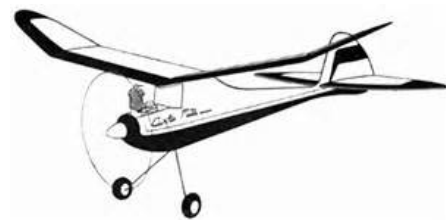
Hoot Owl →

San Diego Orbiteers Flying Schedule 2026 Taibi Field Perris, Ca

<u>Primary Date</u>	<u>Rain Date</u>	<u>Event</u>
March 22	March 29	OT/NOS Rubber/Glider/Power
April 19	April 26	P-30 /Glider/Power
May 17	May 24	Coupe/Glider/Power
June 14	June 28	OT/NOS Rubber/Glider/Power
July 19	July 26	P-30/Glider/Power
August 16	Aug 23	Coupe/Glider/Power
September Hills, Ca	(TBD)	Free Flight Championships, Lost
September 20	September 27	OT/NOS Rubber/Glider/Power
October 18	October 25	P-30/Glider/Power
November	13,14&15	Dual Clubs, Lost Hill, Ca
November 22	November 29	Coupe/Glider/Power
December 13	No Date	Make-up

MP
12/25

SAN DIEGO ORBITEERS
Howard L. Haupt / Editor
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San Diego, California 92117-4266



WHAT'S HAPPENING -

March 22, 2026 - San Diego Orbiteer Outdoor Monthly
Taibi Flying Field, Perris CA, 7:30 start time.
Events: OT-NOS Rubber / Glider / Power